

Vinh-Hung (Tommy) Ly

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Education

Columbia University, New York

May 2025

B.A. Computer Science, Minor in Statistics

GPA: 3.7/4.0

Coursework: Probabilistic Machine Learning (PhD), Statistical Analysis of Neural Data (PhD), Bayesian Statistics, Algorithms, Stochastic Processes, Time Series, Artificial Intelligence

Honors: Knight-Hennessy Scholars semifinalist (top 6% of 8,570 applicants); Columbia GS Honor Society (top 76/semester); Dean's List (6 semesters)

RMIT University Vietnam - Bachelor of Commerce

2013

Industry Experience

Evolve, New York

Jun 2025 - Present

Data Engineer

- Cut Snowflake compute cost on four high-traffic dbt models by converting table to incremental materializations, achieving up to 49x speedup (740s to 15s); tuned 11 additional queries across revenue and forecasting repos.
- Migrated the production pricing pipeline onto a new demand-forecasting data feed over 25+ shipped changes, with shadow-to-production parity testing, deduplication, and guardrails.
- Built the scheduling and email-digest layer for an internal FastAPI app: replaced page-load triggers with an in-process APScheduler job; built a headless screenshot to email pipeline; debugged a refresher-lock deadlock.

Uber Technologies, Vietnam / Singapore / New York

2016 - 2020

Senior Regional Operations Manager

- Designed a SQL/Python spatial-temporal framework over 500k+ trips to identify cross-dispatch opportunities, surfacing market-specific patterns that improved driver utilization; built incentive-burn pipelines validated against experimental results across US/Canada.

Research Experience

Zuckerman Mind Brain Behavior Institute, Columbia University

Summer 2024

Research Intern, Computational Neuroscience

Advisor: Prof. Liam Paninski

- Built a semi-supervised pose-estimation pipeline integrating an Ensemble Kalman Smoother with iterative self-training, achieving 10% improvement over baseline ensembles (pseudo-labeler).

Columbia Irving Medical Center

Summer 2023

Research Intern, Mathematical Genomics

Advisor: Prof. Raúl Rabadán

- Built a hybrid CNN-Transformer for chromatin accessibility prediction over 115 ATAC-seq datasets, reaching Pearson $r = 0.5$ (atac-processing).

Publications

- “A pilot scientific reasoning benchmark for evaluating chain-of-thought interpretability.” M Narayan, H Ly. **International Conference on Machine Learning 2026 Workshop** (under review).

Open Source

- **FrontierScience benchmark** (Inspect Evals): implemented OpenAI's 160-problem expert-reasoning evaluation across physics, chemistry, and biology, with format-specific Olympic and rubric-based Research scorers.
- **Attract-Repel Link Predictor** (PyTorch Geometric, blog post): contributed pseudo-Euclidean attract-repel link prediction for undirected graphs, merged into Pytorch Geometrics core.

Skills & Activities

Languages & Tools: Python, SQL, Java, C, Bash; PyTorch, scikit-learn, Lightning AI, FastAPI, dbt, Terraform, Docker, APScheduler; Snowflake, PostgreSQL; AWS; Git, Linux.

Activities: Ironman Maryland finisher in 14:30 (2.4-mile swim, 112-mile bike, 26.2-mile run).